

The Substitute Pitcher: answers

Grade 5 · 14 points. Accept any sensible answer that is backed up by the text.

1. Marcus, the starting pitcher, twisted his wrist while diving for a ball. (1 point)

Finding information (RL.5.1). The cause is stated in the second paragraph, so the child practices finding and restating it.

2. “gripping her glove so tightly that her knuckles turned white” (accept: “her knuckles turned white”). (2 points)

Quoting from the text (RL.5.1). Quoting accurately means copying the words exactly and putting them in quotation marks.

3. He looked angry, grumpy or unfriendly. (1 point)

Word meaning (RL.5.4). Using a single word to understand a character.

4. She was very nervous. Her legs felt weak and shaky, as if she could hardly stand. (2 points)

Language choices (RL.5.4). Explaining what a simile shows, not just spotting it.

5. Any two of: “legs that felt like jelly”; “heart hammered so loudly”; “gripping her glove so tightly”. (2 points)

Quoting from the text (RL.5.1). Backing up a claim with exact words from the text, which is the Grade 5 reading skill.

6. Remembering him calmed her down. After she pictured him, “Her shoulders loosened.” (2 points)

Inference (RL.5.1). The child explains what the text implies and uses an exact quote as proof.

7. He reminded her to stay relaxed and treat it like a game of catch: “Just play catch!” (2 points)

Explaining from the text. Combining an explanation with an accurate quote.

8. One point for the problem (the starting pitcher was hurt and Dani had to pitch with the bases loaded in the final inning); one for the solution (she calmed herself, remembered her grandfather’s advice, and struck out the batter to win the game). (2 points)

Summarizing (RL.5.2). A summary keeps the main events and leaves out the small details.